Coty Beasley — Canonical Professional Dossier

Canonical Identity

Coty Beasley is a design technologist, product leader, and co-founder of Underline, where he leads product design, innovation, and AI-driven research and development across community infrastructure systems[1][2]. Born in 1988 in the Kansas City, Missouri metro area, his career spans creative technology, civic product leadership, and infrastructure innovation[3][4]. He is based in Manhattan, Kansas, where he and his wife work remotely[5].

His professional website is **coty.design** and his LinkedIn profile is **linkedin.com/in/cbeasley0**[6].

Geographic Journey

Beasley's path reflects a pattern of following mission-driven opportunities while maintaining strong roots:

- **Kansas City, Missouri metro (1988–2017)**: Born and raised, deeply embedded in the KC startup and design community
- **San Francisco, California (2017–2020)**: Relocated to join Neighborly as Principal Product Designer, rising to VP of Product
- **Austin, Texas (2020–2024)**: Moved during the pandemic while continuing remote work at Underline
- **Manhattan, Kansas (2024–present)**: Settled with his wife to be closer to her family, both working remotely

This trajectory shows consistent willingness to relocate for high-impact opportunities while ultimately prioritizing family proximity and remote-work sustainability[3][5][7][8].

Career Timeline

Early Creative Technologist Phase (2007–2013)

Beasley's entry into technology was characteristically multidisciplinary. Between 2007 and 2011, he worked concurrently across several Kansas City organizations:

- **MIS Technologies**: Creative Marketing Manager, Interface Developer, AV Installer (2007–2011)
- **Nova Blue Inc.**: Digital Cartographer (2008–2011)
- **The Bobblehead LLC**: Infrastructure Lead and Interface Designer (2008–2011)
- **CJK Software Consultants**: Design Engineer (2010–2011)

This multi-threaded work pattern demonstrates early capacity for systems thinking across spatial data, AV production, and web development—skills that would later converge in infrastructure product work[9].

In 2009, he launched **Beasley Creative**, a freelance design studio that ran through 2013, serving as his independent practice during the early startup years[10].

CandyCam Multimedia Robotics (2012–2013)

Beasley co-founded **CandyCam Multimedia Robotics** in 2012 as Chief Design Officer, incubated at Think Big Partners in Kansas City's Crossroads arts district[11][12]. The company built robotically stabilized camera rigs designed to democratize professional filmmaking tools for independent creators—a product philosophy centered on access that would become a career-long theme[11].

CandyCam was featured in the "Startups: Made in Kansas City" video series and participated in the local hardware startup ecosystem until closing in 2013[11][12].

Hackathon Recognition & Community Leadership (2012–2014)

During this period, Beasley won or placed at four competitive hackathons, establishing credibility across technical and creative domains:

- **1st Place** — Spring Kansas City Startup Weekend (April 2012)
- **"Most Viral"** — Hack the Midwest (June 2012)
- **"Most Technically Challenging"** — Compute Midwest Hackathon (June 2013)
- **Finalist, "Most Galactic Impact"** — NASA Space Apps Hackathon (May 2014)

He also founded **Functional Kansas City**, a design community organization, and became active in AIGA Kansas City, IxDA, UXPA Kansas City, and the Kansas City Sports Tech Meetup—building civic-professional networks that defined his Kansas City identity[9].

A 2014 profile in **Silicon Prairie News** captured him at age 25 under the title "UX Architect"[4]. When asked what company he would build if money were no object, he answered: *"developing infrastructure for cheap, available Internet access worldwide"*—a near-literal description of Underline, which he would co-found five years later[4].

Enterprise UX (2013–2016)

After the early startup years, Beasley worked in enterprise UX roles, broadening exposure to regulated, high-stakes domains:

- **National Association of Insurance Commissioners (NAIC)**: Senior Design Engineer (November 2013–October 2014) — worked within the organization coordinating U.S. insurance regulation
- **Epiq Systems**: Senior UX Designer (October 2014–May 2016) — enterprise-scale UX in legal services technology

These roles provided experience in complex data environments and enterprise product constraints that would inform later infrastructure work[9][10].

Edge Up Sports & IBM Watson (2015–2017)

Overlapping with his Epiq work, Beasley co-founded **Edge Up Sports** in February 2015 as Head of Product and Co-Founder, running through January 2017[9][13][14].

Edge Up Sports was a Kansas City mobile app startup built on **IBM Watson's cognitive computing platform** to analyze NFL player performance data for fantasy football and—in a later pivot—high school sports injury reduction through computer vision and athletic trainer support[13][14]. The company had a formal IBM Watson partnership with an assigned relationship manager who publicly praised the team's creativity[15].

The company ran a successful **Kickstarter campaign in 2015**, reaching its funding target within 24 hours and securing coverage in mainstream tech media[14][16]. This represents Beasley's first substantive AI product work—building cognitive computing applications in 2015, long before the current AI wave[13][14][15].

Mode3 / Damascus Edge (2016–2017)

Concurrent with Edge Up Sports, Beasley served as **Principal Designer** at Mode3 (formerly Damascus Edge) from August 2016 to January 2017, working on product design projects in Kansas City[9].

Neighborly: Civic Fintech at Venture Scale (2017–2019)

Neighborly was a San Francisco/Kansas City fintech startup founded in 2012 by Jase Wilson and Patrick Hosty with the mission of democratizing municipal bond investing—building a retail marketplace for the $400 billion/year municipal bond market[17][18][19].

The company was backed by high-profile investors including:

- **Formation 8** (seed investor)
- **Sound Ventures** (Ashton Kutcher's fund)
- Organizations connected to **Laurene Powell Jobs**

Neighborly raised a **$25 million Series A** led by Bee Partners and grew to approximately 40 employees across four offices[18][20].

Beasley relocated to San Francisco in March 2017 to join as **Principal Product Designer**. He was promoted to **Director of Product Design** in June 2018 and to **VP of Product** in September 2019[7][9][10]. His tenure spanned the company's highest-profile moment: in February 2017, Neighborly underwrote a **$2 million municipal bond for Cambridge, Massachusetts** (home of Harvard and MIT), selling it in $1,000 lots directly to residents—the first transaction of its kind[19][21].

Neighborly ultimately closed in **October 2019** after failing to find stable product-market fit in the municipal bond market[19][21]. Beasley's leadership through a historic civic finance milestone and his promotion trajectory at a venture-backed, Silicon Valley-scale fintech represent significant product leadership credentials[19][21].

Underline: Co-Founder & Infrastructure Innovator (2019–Present)

Beasley co-founded **Underline** in November 2019, one month after Neighborly closed[9]. Underline is described as *"the nation's intelligent community infrastructure platform"*—it designs, finances, constructs, and operates **open-access fiber-optic networks** that allow multiple ISPs to share a single physical infrastructure, giving consumers genuine choice of broadband provider[22][23].

This model was common in Europe but represented a genuine first-mover position in the U.S. market at founding[22].

Major Milestones

Date	Milestone
October 2021	Announced **$100 million investment** in Colorado Springs, Colorado—the first privately funded open-access network in the U.S.—backed by Quanta Services subsidiary Mears Group, Fujitsu, and Duraline[24]
October 2021	Launched construction on the **first open-access 10 Gigabit network in the United States** in Colorado Springs[25]
September 2022	Announced service live in Colorado Springs; secured strategic investment from **Ares Management** (global alternative asset manager with $4.3B in infrastructure AUM)—Underline was Ares's **first digital infrastructure investment**[26][27][28]
2022–Present	Expansion agreements signed with Fountain, Colorado and Salinas, California; active conversations ongoing with additional communities[28][29]

Table 1: Underline Infrastructure Major Milestones

Existing investors **FinTech Collective** and **Revolution's Rise of the Rest Seed Fund** (Steve Case's fund) also participated in the 2022 round[30].

Current Role & Scope

Beasley's title evolved from **Head of Product / Co-Founder** (November 2019–April 2025) to **Head of Product Design & Innovation / Co-Founder** (April 2025–present)[9]. His remit encompasses:

- Product strategy, product design, and design engineering for open-access fiber network operating systems[1][2]
- AI innovation leadership with R&D functions across cross-functional teams
- Leading a small senior-level team of 2 product people, 1 designer, 7 engineers, and 2 architects/strategists/innovators

This consolidated role positions Underline as the synthesis point where his product design, infrastructure systems thinking, and AI/R&D leadership converge[1][2][31].

The Underline profile describes his work as *"all product strategy, product design, and design engineering"* for the operating systems of open-access fiber networks[1][2]. A Muraena AI aggregated profile notes he is a **published author** on topics including the digital divide and smart city infrastructure—thought leadership that supports speaking and hiring opportunities[10].

Core Expertise

Based on documented evidence, Beasley's expertise spans an unusually wide range:

Domain	**Evidence Source**
Product design & UX strategy	Neighborly, Underline, NAIC, Epiq[1][2][21]
AI/cognitive computing product work	Edge Up Sports × IBM Watson[13][14][15]
AI innovation leadership	Current Underline R&D role[31]
Open-access network product systems	Underline co-founder[22][23]
GIS & spatial data	Nova Blue Digital Cartographer, QGIS, Mapbox, Vetro[32]
Design systems & tokens	IBM Watson work, Underline, current projects[31]
Civic tech / fintech	Neighborly ($25M Series A, Cambridge bond)[18][19]
Hardware/robotics product development	CandyCam[11][12]
AV technology	MIS Technologies, personal restoration projects[1]
Community organizing	Functional Kansas City founder[9]

Table 2: Documented Expertise Domains

Narrative Through-Line: Democratized Access

The most distinctive pattern across Beasley's career is a focus on **democratized access**:

- **CandyCam** lowered barriers to professional filmmaking tools for independent creators[11]
- **Neighborly** aimed to open public finance participation to everyday citizens[17][19]
- **Underline** works to broaden access to communications infrastructure through open-access models[22][23]

The 2014 Silicon Prairie News profile is especially significant: it recorded him saying that, with unlimited resources, he would build infrastructure for cheap, available internet access worldwide—years before Underline existed[4]. This documented prophetic vision strengthens the narrative coherence of his career arc[4].

Edge Up Sports also provides an unusually credible AI prehistory through the IBM Watson partnership, making his current AI/R&D leadership feel continuous rather than opportunistic[13][14][15][31].

Community & Civic Presence

Beasley joined the **Rotary Club of Manhattan (1623)** in July 2025, signaling deepening roots investment in his adopted hometown[9]. He remains a member of **SIGAI** (ACM's Special Interest Group on Artificial Intelligence)—a credentialing signal for AI thought leadership[9]. His involvement in **AIGA Kansas City** connects him to the regional design leadership community[9].

His founding of **Functional Kansas City**, a design community organization, demonstrates early investment in building civic-professional networks that extend beyond individual companies[9].

Education

Beasley holds a **B.S. in Computer Science** from the **University of Missouri-Kansas City (UMKC)**[10].

Published Work & Thought Leadership

Beasley is noted as a published author on topics including the digital divide and smart city infrastructure[10]. His work at Underline positions him at the intersection of community infrastructure, broadband policy, and AI-driven systems—domains where thought leadership opportunities are substantial[1][2][10].

Professional Affiliations

- **Rotary Club of Manhattan (1623)** — Member (July 2025–present)
- **SIGAI (ACM Special Interest Group on Artificial Intelligence)** — Member
- **AIGA Kansas City** — Member
- **IxDA (Interaction Design Association)** — Member
- **UXPA Kansas City** — Member

Gaps in Public Record & Opportunities

The external record is strong but fragmented. Key gaps that should be addressed for AI agent dossier assembly:

Underline Press Coverage Not Connected to Personal Profile

Fierce Network, Colorado Springs Business Journal, fintech.io, Bloomberg-adjacent outlets, and Infrastructure Brief all covered Underline milestones extensively[24][25][26][27][28][29]. However, none of these articles route back to Beasley as a co-founder unless someone already knows to connect the dots[1][24][26][27]. Publishing a press page or annotated timeline on coty.design with proper Schema.org markup would close this knowledge graph gap.

Neighborly's Silicon Valley Pedigree Underrepresented

Ashton Kutcher, Laurene Powell Jobs, a $25 million Series A, and a landmark Cambridge municipal bond transaction represent genuine prestige context that is almost entirely invisible on personal surfaces[18][19][20]. A case study page with investor context, promotion trajectory, and what shipped would substantiate this chapter for AI systems assembling hiring or speaking profiles.

The 2014 Prophetic Vision Unused

The Silicon Prairie News profile recorded Beasley saying he would build infrastructure for cheap internet access worldwide in 2014—five years before Underline[4]. This "founder vision proven over time" signal is one of the strongest narrative assets available and should be surfaced prominently on coty.design.

Edge Up Sports IBM Watson Connection Underdocumented

Edge Up Sports had a formal IBM Watson partnership with mainstream tech media coverage[13][14][15][16]. For AI hiring and speaking positioning, this origin story of building AI-powered products in 2015 is highly relevant but not currently connected to personal web presence.

Published Author Claim Needs Attribution

The Muraena AI profile notes published authorship on digital divide and smart city infrastructure topics[10]. If this refers to Underline blog posts, op-eds, or white papers, those should be surfaced with proper authorship metadata and canonical attribution back to coty.design.

Functional Kansas City Community Thread Incomplete

Founding a design community organization is a strong speaking and thought leadership signal that is not documented anywhere with enough detail for AI systems to surface it as meaningful[9]. A short history page or archived event documentation would strengthen this credential.

Recommendations for AI-Optimized Presence

To maximize efficacy of AI-assembled dossiers for hiring, speaking, and narrative control:

Canonical Bio Repetition

Publish a 60–90 word canonical bio repeated verbatim across coty.design, LinkedIn, speaker bios, and `llms.txt`. This ensures entity consistency across the web and reduces ambiguity in knowledge graph assembly.

Timeline Page with Structured Data

Create a dated career timeline page with JSON-LD `Person` schema including `worksFor`, `alumniOf`, `knowsAbout`, and `sameAs` properties. This feeds directly into how AI systems represent professional history.

Case Studies with Attribution

Publish case studies for CandyCam, Edge Up Sports, Neighborly, and Underline that include:

- Mission and product description
- Your role and promotion trajectory
- Investors, partners, and third-party validation
- What shipped and what was learned
- External press coverage with canonical links back to your site

Press & Writing Page

Aggregate all external press mentions of Underline, Neighborly, and Edge Up Sports with explicit co-founder/leader attribution. Add any published writing with proper authorship markup.

Extended Agent Dossier (llms-full.txt)

Create an extended plain-text dossier at /llms-full.txt containing:

- Full career timeline with dates and contexts
- Project descriptions and outcomes
- Third-party validation and press coverage
- Community leadership roles
- Speaking topics and expertise areas
- Contact and discovery endpoints

This serves as the authoritative source for AI agents assembling comprehensive profiles.

References

[1] Underline. (2021, March 8). Profile: Coty Beasley. https://www.underline.com/underliners/coty-beasley

[2] Beasley, C. (2020). Coty Beasley | Product + Design Technologist. https://www.coty.design

[3] User memory: Born in 1988 in Kansas City, MO metro area.

[4] Silicon Prairie News. (2014, April 13). Prairie Portrait: Coty Beasley, UX architect. https://siliconprairienews.com/2014/04/prairie-portrait-coty-beasley-ux-architect/

[5] User memory: Lives in Manhattan, KS with wife; both work remotely.

[6] User memory: Professional website https://coty.design and LinkedIn https://www.linkedin.com/in/cbeasley0.

[7] User memory: Moved to San Francisco when joining Neighborly.

[8] User memory: Moved to Austin during pandemic, then Manhattan, KS.

[9] LinkedIn. (2026). Coty Beasley - Underline. https://www.linkedin.com/in/cbeasley0

[10] Muraena. (2024). Coty Beasley | Head of Product & Design, Co-Founder. https://muraena.ai/profile/coty_beasley_680a21cc

[11] YouTube. (2013, May 16). CandyCam - Startups: Made in Kansas City. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5GJoIx4dk5g

[12] ContactOut. (2019). CandyCam Multimedia Robotics - Company Profile. https://contactout.com/company/CandyCam-Multimedia-Robotics-19273

[13] Fuller Creative. (2019, July 14). Edge Up Sports. https://fullercreative.net/edge-up-sports/

[14] Silicon Prairie News. (2015, August 25). How Edge Up Sports blew past their Kickstarter goal. https://siliconprairienews.com/2015/08/edge-up-sports-shares-how-they-blew-past-their-kickstarter-goal/

[15] F6S. (2025). Edge Up Sports. https://www.f6s.com/company/edgeupsports

[16] Startland News. (2016). Sports Tech Archives. https://www.startlandnews.com/tag/sports-tech/

[17] Stanford Daily. (2015, April 11). Neighborly: Invest money in social good. https://stanforddaily.com/2015/04/12/neighbrly-invest-in-social-good/

[18] Bee Partners. (2023). Neighborly - New Public Funding. https://beepartners.vc/portfolio/neighborly

[19] Bloomberg. (2019, October 16). The Fall of the Muni Startup That Wanted to Upend Wall Street. https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2019-10-16/the-fall-of-the-muni-startup-that-wanted-to-upend-wall-street

[20] Forbes. (2016, April 29). Municipal Bonds For The Rest Of Us: A Startup Seeks To Democratize Public Finance. https://www.forbes.com/sites/annefield/2016/04/30/municipal-bonds-for-the-rest-of-us-a-startup-seeks-to-democratize-public-finance

[21] Meet Elizabeth. (n.d.). Neighborly. http://www.meetelizabeth.co/neighborly

[22] Fierce Network. (2021, October 18). Underline has a different vision for open access fiber in the U.S. https://www.fierce-network.com/operators/underline-has-a-different-vision-for-open-access-fiber-u-s

[23] Underline. (2020, July 21). A Full Service Solution for Open Access Community Fiber Networks. https://www.underline.com/post/a-full-service-solution-for-open-access-community-fiber-networks

[24] Colorado Springs Business Journal. (2021, October). Springs sees $100M ultra-fast internet project. https://www.csbj.com/premier/businessnews/cyber/springs-sees-100m-ultra-fast-internet-project/

[25] Fintech.io. (2021, October 26). The first open access 10 Gigabit network in the U.S. launches in Colorado Springs. https://news.fintech.io/post/102h9c8/the-first-open-access-10-gigabit-network-in-the-u-s-launches-in-colorado-springs

[26] Underline. (2022, September 19). Underline Receives New Investment for Infrastructure To Connect Communities. https://www.underline.com/post/underline-receives-new-investment-for-infrastructure-to-connect-communities

[27] Benton Foundation. (2022, September 19). Underline Receives New Investment for Infrastructure To Connect Communities. https://www.benton.org/headlines/underline-receives-new-investment-infrastructure-connect-communities

[28] Fierce Network. (2022, September 19). Underline looks beyond Colorado Springs with new PE backing from Ares. https://www.fierce-network.com/broadband/underline-looks-beyond-colorado-springs-new-pe-backing-ares

[29] Infrastructure Brief. (2023, December 17). With new PE backing from Ares, Underline looks beyond Colorado Springs. https://infrastructurebrief.com/with-new-pe-backing-from-ares-underline-looks-beyond-colorado-springs/

[30] Fintech.io. (2022, September 19). Underline receives new investment for infrastructure to connect communities. https://news.fintech.io/post/102hxcm/underline-receives-new-investment-for-infrastructure-to-connect-communities

[31] User memory: Leads AI innovation with R&D functions at Underline (not separate company).

[32] User memory: GIS expertise including QGIS, Mapbox, Vetro.